

## Summary

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I am an economist at the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO). Before taking up my current post, I was a researcher at the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences and a lecturer at the Stockholm School of Economics (the Swedish Program). Experienced in stakeholder engagement, policy analysis, project management, proposal development, and grant applications. Extensive international expertise through research visits, missions, conferences, and workshops. I widely use quantitative methods (experimental and quasi-experimental research design) to provide policy-oriented research outputs.

## Areas of Research Interest

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Primary areas: Agriculture and Environmental Economics, Development Economics, and Health Economics

Secondary areas: Applied Spatial and Microeconometrics, Computable General Equilibrium (CGE) Modeling

## Education

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| PhD, Economics, Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Uppsala-Sweden          | 2014-2019      |
| Visiting PhD student, University of Western Australia, Perth-Australia               | June-Aug. 2018 |
| MSc., Economics, Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Uppsala-Sweden         | 2010-2013      |
| MSc., Rural Development, Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Uppsala-Sweden | 2009-2011      |
| BA., Economics, Jimma University, Jimma, Ethiopia                                    | 2004-2007      |

## Employment History

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| Economist - United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)                                            | Jan. 2022 to present   |
| Policy Analyst - United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)                                       | Sept. 2021 - Dec. 2021 |
| Researcher - Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences                                                      | Jan. 2019 - Dec. 2020  |
| Doctoral Researcher - Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences<br>Department of Economics, Uppsala, Sweden | Aug. 2014 - Dec. 2018  |
| Research Assistant - Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences,<br>Department of Economics, Uppsala, Sweden | Dec. 2013 - May 2014   |
| Junior Planner - Ethio Telecom, Transformation Program Office,<br>Addis Ababa, Ethiopia                       | Sept. 2007 - Oct. 2009 |

## Selected Peer Reviewed Articles

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- (1) Acosta, A., Tirkaso, W.T., Atravia, M., Nicolli, F., Chatzopoulos, T., Araujo-Enciso, S.R., Cicowiez, M., Eskander, S., Laxminarayan, R., and Song, J. (2026). Antimicrobial Use in Livestock: The Economic Cost of Action or Inaction. *Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 0, 1–23.
- (2) Tirkaso, W.T., Acosta, A., Nicolli, F., Van Boeckel, T., and Song, J. (2025). The Future of Antimicrobial Use in Livestock. *Nature Communications*, 16(1), 2469.
- (3) Tirkaso, W.T., and Hailu, A. (2022). Does Neighborhood Matter? The Effect of Spatial Proximity on Farmers Technical Efficiency Level. *Agricultural Economics*, 1–13.
- (4) Tirkaso, W.T., Marbuah, G., and Gren, I-M. (2021). Social capital, economic development and carbon emissions: Empirical evidence from counties in Sweden. *Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews*, 152, 111691.
- (5) Tirkaso, W.T., and Gren, I-M. (2021). Costs and equity of uncertain greenhouse gas reductions: Fuel, food and negative emissions in Sweden. *Energy Economics*, 105638.

- (6) Tirkaso, W.T., and Gren, I-M. (2021). Evaluation of cost efficiency in hydropower-related biodiversity restoration projects in Sweden – a stochastic frontier approach. *Journal of Environmental Planning and Management*, 1–21.
- (7) Tirkaso, W.T., and Gren, I-M. (2020). Road fuel demand and regional effects of carbon taxes in Sweden. *Energy Policy*, 144, 111648.
- (8) Tirkaso, W.T., and Nsabimana, A. (2019). Examining coffee export performance in Eastern and Southern African countries: Do bilateral trade relations matter? *Agrekon*, 59(1), 46–64.

## Working Papers and Book Chapters

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- (1) Tirkaso, W.T. (2023). On the Impact of Rural Electrification: The Role of Complementary Factors. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4377190>
- (2) Tirkaso, W.T., Sandin, Leonard., Segersten, Joel., Spjut, David., and Degerman, Erik.(2018). Selected Studies in Biodiversity. In Şen, Bülent(Ed.), “Biodiversity Restoration and Renewable Energy from Hydropower: Conflict or Synergy?”. pp. 120-131. ISBN:978-1-78923-233-2.
- (3) Marbuah, G., Tirkaso, W.T., and Gren, I-M. (2016). Cost-effective Policy and Incomplete Information on Policy Implementation. In H., Liljenström and U, Svedin (Ed.), ”Towards a Fossil-Free Society - in the Stockholm-Mälars Region”. pp. 134-152. ISBN: 978-91-976048-4-0

## Technical and programming skills

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- Production of Technical and Scientific Documentation: Microsoft Office and LaTeX
- Econometrics and Data Analysis Softwares: Stata, R, ArcGIS/QGIS and Python (basic).

## Teaching experience

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Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Department of Economics

Microeconomics (Bachelor level course)

Spring 2016

Environmental Economics (Bachelor level course)

Spring 2016

The Swedish Program - Stockholm School of Economics (SSE)

Energy and Environmental Economics (Bachelor level course)

Fall 2021, Spring 2022

## Workshops, conference and presentations

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- (1) The 2019 AAEA Annual Meeting. Agricultural & Applied Economics Association, Atlanta, 21-23 July 2019.
- (2) 26<sup>th</sup> Ulvön Conference on Environmental Economics. Umeå University and the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences (SLU), Sweden, 18-20 June 2019.
- (3) EAAE Seminar 168: Behavioural Perspectives in Agricultural Economics and Management. The Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences (SLU), Sweden, 6-7 February 2019.
- (4) 2<sup>nd</sup> Nordic Annual Environmental and Resource Economics (NAERE) Workshop. Norwegian School of Economics (NHH), Norway, 12-13 April. 2018.
- (5) 15<sup>th</sup> European Workshop on Efficiency and Productivity Analysis (EWEPA). Loughborough University, UK, 12-15 June. 2017.
- (6) Euroleague for Life Science Scientific(ELLS) Student Conference. University of Hohenheim, Germany, 11-12 November. 2016.
- (7) International Society of Ecological Economics (ISEE) 2016 Conference. University of the District of Columbia, USA, 26-29 June. 2016.
- (8) Euroleague for Life Science Scientific(ELLS) Student Conference. Boku University of Natural Resource and Life Sciences, Austria, 14-16, November. 2013.
- (9) Evaluation of Cost Efficiency in Hydro-Power Related Biodiversity Restoration Projects in Sweden. Centre for Environmental and Resource Economics (CERE), Umea Univeristy, Sweden, 25 October. 2017.